

Mitsue Village — Native Broadleaf Species List

Prepared for: 上坂奈穂様 (Nao Uesaka), Mizuho Securities — Sustainability Promotion Dept. **Purpose:** Reference list of native broadleaf ("satoyama") species targeted for reforestation as aging sugi (cedar) and hinoki (cypress) plantations are thinned, in place of replanting more conifer monoculture.

Why these species

Selection favors trees that (a) are native to Mitsue's satoyama and ridge habitats, (b) provide seed/mast forage that keeps deer, boar, and bear in the forest rather than farmland, and (c) include at least one species — Kihada — with an existing local/regional market (medicinal bark, furniture) so the forest has an economic path alongside its ecological one. Final species mix and site allocation is expected to be a joint decision with more trees and the local forest cooperative (地域林業パートナー).

Species list

English	日本語	Latin name	Habitat in Mitsue	Value
Japanese beech	ブナ	<i>Fagus crenata</i>	Ridges & upper slopes	Mast feeds bear & boar; climax-forest indicator
Mizunara oak	ミズナラ	<i>Quercus crispula</i>	Moist mid-upper slopes	Acorns are key bear forage
Konara oak	コナラ	<i>Quercus serrata</i>	Satoyama secondary woods	Acorns, charcoal, shiitake logs
Sawtooth oak	クヌギ	<i>Quercus acutissima</i>	Lower sunny slopes	Acorns; sap draws insects
Horse chestnut	トチノキ	<i>Aesculus turbinata</i>	Streamsides & valleys	Large heritage trees; seeds used for tochi-mochi
Japanese nutmeg-yew	カヤ	<i>Torreya nucifera</i>	Shrine groves, slopes	Sacred, slow-growing, edible seed
Wild mountain cherry	ヤマザクラ	<i>Cerasus jamasakura</i>	Mixed slopes	Spring bloom; fruit eaten by birds
Japanese maple	イロハモミジ	<i>Acer palmatum</i>	Valleys, understory	Biodiversity, autumn color
Bigleaf magnolia	ホオノキ	<i>Magnolia obovata</i>	Moist slopes	Large flowers feed pollinators
Japanese zelkova	ケヤキ	<i>Zelkova serrata</i>	Valley floors, village edge	Heritage shade trees
Japanese chestnut	クリ	<i>Castanea crenata</i>	Sunny satoyama slopes	Nuts feed people & wildlife
Katsura	カツラ	<i>Cercidiphyllum japonicum</i>	Streamsides	Heritage trees, fragrant autumn foliage

English	日本語	Latin name	Habitat in Mitsue	Value
Kihada (Amur cork tree)	キハダ	<i>Phellodendron amurense</i>	Mixed slopes	Bark used for <i>Daranisuke</i> (陀羅尼助), a 1,300-yr-old herbal medicine currently sourced outside Nara Prefecture; also used in furniture. Leading candidate for a marketable broadleaf product.

Candidate additions — sacred-grove (shrine forest) species

Species named in Omura (2004), *Trees, Forests and Religion in Japan*, as historically tied to Shinto/Buddhist forests of warm-temperate SW Japan (full note: docs/reference/omura_2004_trees_forests_religion_japan.md).

Literature-based only: not yet field-verified for Mitsue's elevation, cold tolerance or local presence.

Check against the field survey before adding to any planting plan.

English	日本語	Latin name	Role (per Omura 2004)	Check before use
Sakaki	サカキ	<i>Cleyera japonica</i>	Evergreen pioneer; twigs offered at shrines; marks holy boundaries	Small tree; confirm cold hardiness
Ogatama tree	オガタマノキ	<i>Magnolia compressa</i> (syn. <i>Michelia compressa</i>)	Planted at shrine gates ("inviting the god's soul")	Warm-climate species; confirm Mitsue is not too cold
Nagi	ナギ	<i>Nageia nagi</i> (Omura: <i>Podocarpus nagi</i>)	Pure stand in the protected Mikasayama forest at Kasuga-taisha, Nara	A broad-leaved conifer; confirm it grows at Mitsue's altitude
Evergreen oaks (Cyclobalanopsis group)	カシ類	<i>Quercus</i> subg. <i>Cyclobalanopsis</i>	Dominant in shrine forests; acorns were a staple food in SW Japan	Omura names no species; pick local ones (e.g. from the field survey)
Japanese star anise	シキミ	<i>Illicium religiosum</i>	Twigs offered to gods and the dead	Toxic fruit and seeds: avoid near children and livestock
Camphor tree	クスノキ	<i>Cinnamomum camphora</i>	Large sacred trees at shrines and temples	Warm lowland species; likely marginal at Mitsue's altitude

Omura also lists pine (*Pinus densiflora*, *P. thunbergii*), bamboo, Japanese cedar and zelkova as religious trees. Zelkova is already on the list above. Pine is a conifer pioneer and bamboo is not a reforestation target, so they are left out here.

Planting method

Species reintroduction follows the **su-植え (巣植え, "nest planting")** cluster method used by more trees at their Tenkawa Village project: three saplings planted in a tight triangle ("nest"), nests spaced widely apart across the site. This halves undergrowth-clearing labor, reduces total saplings needed per hectare, and lets native shrubs and grasses fill the gaps between nests — while the close spacing of each nest makes it harder for deer to strip the central buds.

Status

Species selection and site allocation are not yet finalized — this list reflects the native-species checklist compiled for our own field survey (Mitsue Mother Tree Project) and conversations with more trees, not a signed planting plan.

Sources

- Mitsue Heritage Tree Field Guide (project field-survey material, 2026-06)
- more trees Tenkawa Village project — <https://www.more-trees.org/category/forests/project14/>
- more trees Annual Report 2025 (project reference material)
- Mitsue Forest Workforce & Energy Plan (Kihada bark market note)
- Omura H. (2004) *Trees, Forests and Religion in Japan*, Mountain Research and Development 24(2): 179–182. doi:10.1659/0276-4741(2004)024[0179:TFARIJ]2.0.CO;2 (candidate additions table)